

V. JAGANNATH

RETAIL LEASING DIRECTOR – UAE & GCC PORTFOLIO | TAILORED FOR BLACKROCK

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EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Senior Real Estate & Asset Management Executive with 20+ years of documented UAE & India institutional experience, specializing in Portfolio Strategy, Commercial Leasing, CAPEX Prioritization, and NOI Optimization across diversified assets. Track record includes directing an **AED 800M Real Estate Portfolio**, negotiating **2,500+ commercial lease agreements**, and overseeing **800,000 sq. ft. of luxury retail and B2B commercial space** across flagship Investment Corporation of Dubai (ICD) developments. Demonstrates proven commercial judgement in asset repositioning, tenant strategy, and institutional stakeholder negotiations.

KEY CAREER METRICS

AED 800M Real Estate Portfolio	800,000 Sq. Ft. Luxury & B2B Leasing Scope	2,500+ Leases Negotiated with Landlords/Tenants
300+ Locations Catchment & Feasibility Studies	200+ Properties Operations & Performance	6,000+ Contacts Executive Decision-Maker Network

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Ithra Dubai LLC | Investment Corporation of Dubai (ICD) — Dubai, UAE

Leasing Lead – Retail & Commercial Asset Management (2020-03 – 2025-12)

Mandate spanning Commercial Leasing, Tenant strategy, Portfolio performance, Financial planning, Asset positioning, Stakeholder negotiations and Governance across flagship ICD-backed developments.

- Directed leasing across 800,000 sq. ft. of luxury retail & B2B commercial space across One Za'abeel, Deira Enrichment Project, The Plaza - Deira, and Waterfront Market.
- Structured and negotiated commercial lease agreements with corporate occupiers, luxury retailers, and institutional landlords.
- Managed portfolio financial planning, annual budgets, expenditure forecasts, and CAPEX priorities supporting NOI objectives.
- Ensured full compliance with RERA regulations and corporate governance standards.

Ghassan Aboud Group — Dubai, UAE

Real Estate Manager & Business Development (2017-05 – 2019-09)

Managed Real Estate Assets and Commercial Development activities across a diversified Portfolio encompassing Residential, Commercial, Luxury and Mixed-use properties.

- Evaluated real estate and portfolio opportunities through financial feasibility and market-demand analysis.
- Maintained strategic relationships with master developers, investors, and business owners.

Grandiose Supermarkets (Ghassan Aboud Group) | Ghassan Aboud Group — Dubai, UAE

Business Development Manager – Store Expansion (2017-05 – 2019-08)

Led Real Estate-driven Portfolio and Store expansion activities across the UAE.

- Supported strategic expansion through 300+ site evaluations and 35+ commercial lease agreements.
- Conducted demographic and catchment analysis, footfall assessment, and CAPEX planning for five-year expansion.

Prime Hill Properties — Dubai, UAE

Sales, Leasing & Property Manager (2011-01 – 2017-05)

Managed Leasing, Property Management, Sales and Property operations across a portfolio of 200+ Residential and Commercial units.

- Achieved sustained occupancy and optimized rental yield across residential and commercial units.
- Oversaw tenant lifecycle, lease renewals, tenancy administration, and pricing strategies.

Poplar Homes Real Estate — Dubai, UAE

Property Manager – Leasing & Sales (2007-08 – 2010-12)

Led Property Leasing, Property Management, Pricing, Client acquisition, Financial administration and Leasing-team activities.

- Originated high-value tenancy contracts and managed client acquisition during volatile market cycles.
- Led leasing team operations and financial reporting.

CREDENTIALS & EDUCATION

- **Certified Retail Management Expert (2026)**: Retail Asset Management, Tenant Mix Strategy, Commercial Yield Optimization.
- **RERA Certification (2011–2016)**: Real Estate Regulatory Agency, Dubai.
- **Bachelor's Degree in Hotel Management (2002)**: American University of Hawaii.
- **Affiliations**: Middle East Council of Shopping Centers (MECSC, 2011–2016), National Association of Realtors (NAR, 2017).
- **Languages**: English (Fluent), Hindi (Fluent), Urdu (Fluent), Telugu (Native).